

Sound Cards



This card is present in almost all computers. Sound cards are available for PCI slots, and are yet to be available for the PCIe format. ISA sound cards have long become obsolete, and if you have one, you should upgrade because they are more resource-hungry, and are limited to a sampling rate of 16 bits at 44,100 Hz. Newer PCI sound cards such as the Audigy2 can sample at 24 bits at 96 KHz, which is the specification for DVD quality audio disks. Most new motherboards have an on-board sound card which gives you a free PCI slot for further expansion options, and which also provides decent performance in the sound department. Of course, there are PCI sound cards available, such as the Creative Audigy 2, which is one of the best sound cards available for the home user segment.